THREE DAYS · TWO WALKERS · LATE AUTUMN

Kyoto in Autumn

A walking plan for two people who travel for temples, for long paths under maple, and for the food that comes with them — yudofu, unagi, sake, market stalls and one proper kaiseki.

3	~38 km	¥92,800
DAYS, ONE DISTRICT EACH	ON FOOT, IN TOTAL	FOR TWO, THREE DAYS

Prepared 15 October 2026. Built for a late-autumn visit — dates are given wherever a temple publishes them. Opening hours and admission were checked against official sites on 15 October 2026; Kyoto raises its fees without much warning, so the two or three figures marked *check* are worth a glance before you go. Every stop has a map link.

Before you start

The three days are drawn as three clean walks, each in one part of the city, each with a food thread running through it. You spend almost no time on transport between them, and the walking *is* the sightseeing: canals, temple lanes, hillside graveyards, kitchen streets. Every stop lists what it costs, when it opens, and a link to it on a map.

Currency and fees

All prices are in yen, per adult, and include tax. Temples charge at the gate in cash unless noted. A "grounds free" temple still charges for its buildings and gardens — those are listed separately here.

Transport

A city bus ride is a flat **¥230**; the subway runs about **¥220–360**. The **Subway & Bus 1-Day Pass is ¥1,100** and pays for itself at about five rides, which most of these days reach.

Timing

Two of the three days start deliberately early. Kiyomizu-dera opens at 06:00 and Fushimi Inari never closes; being there before 07:30 is the difference between a temple and a queue.

Booking ahead

Two things need planning: unagi at Hirokawa in Arashiyama (phone bookings, weeks ahead) and anything kaiseki. The Nintendo Museum, if you want it as a rainy-day fallback, is an advance ticket lottery only.

Transport, precisely

TICKET	PRICE	WHAT IT COVERS
City bus, single ride	¥230	Flat fare inside the central zone; child ¥120.
Subway, single ride	¥220–360	By distance, Karasuma and Tōzai lines.
Subway & Bus 1-Day Pass	¥1,100	All city buses and both subway lines, plus Kyoto Bus on the Ohara and Daikakuji routes, Keihan buses in Yamashina/Daigo, and the JR Bus Takao line. Bought on the bus, at subway ticket machines or at the Bus & Subway Information Centre.
Subway 1-Day Pass	¥800	Subway only; worth it only if you stay underground.
Sightseeing Limited Express Bus	¥500	The tourist express services to Kiyomizu-dera and Gion; costs more than a normal ride, so only useful when the queue at the ordinary stop is long.

> **One thing to ignore in older guides:** the ¥700 city-bus-only one-day pass was withdrawn (sales ended in 2023, invalid after 31 March 2024). The ¥1,100 subway-and-bus pass is its replacement. Separately, Kyoto has announced a higher bus fare for visitors (roughly ¥350–400 against ¥200 for residents), but that is legislated for fiscal 2027 — the flat ¥230 fare still applies for a late-2026 trip.

DAY ONE · EASTERN KYOTO

The Eastern Walk, southward

Ginkaku-ji → Kiyomizu-dera
~15 km on foot

START	FINISH	TEMPLES & ENTRY	FOOD THREAD
08:30 Ginkaku-ji	**Kiyomizu-dera, lit up**	**~¥5,000**	**Yudofu · matcha**

The classic Higashiyama traverse, run in the direction that gets the light right: you start beside the Silver Pavilion while the moss is still damp, follow the canal south, and finish on the Kiyomizu stage as the city goes dark. Everything between is one continuous walk — no bus except the first one of the day.

TIME	STOP	HOURS · FEE	
08:30	**Ginkaku-ji, the Silver Pavilion** A dry Zen garden of raked sand and a moss garden with dozens of named mosses, on the hillside above the canal. Go straight up and round the loop before the coaches arrive. Autumn special viewing is on: 1 Nov – 5 Dec 2026. `Bus 5, 17 or 100 to Ginkakuji-michi`	**¥1,000** 08:30–17:00 (Mar–Nov) Raised from ¥500 on 1 Apr 2026	Map
09:45	**Philosopher's Path** Two kilometres of canal, cherry trees and small stone bridges, named for the professor who walked it to the university. In late November it is the maples over the water that matter. Flat, open at all hours. `Starts beside Ginkaku-ji, runs south`	Free Open, no closing time	Map
10:15	**Hōnen-in** A few minutes off the path, up a steep flight to a thatched gate and two raised cones of white sand. Almost always empty. The buildings open to the public only twice a year — in autumn, 18–24 November. `Left off the path at its north end`	Grounds free 06:00–16:00	Map
10:45	**Eikan-dō (Zenrin-ji)** The most spectacular maple temple on this walk: a valley of trees above a pond, a pagoda at the top, and the Mikaeri Amida who looks back over his shoulder. The autumn treasure exhibition runs 11 Nov – 6 Dec and pushes the price up. `Bus stop Nanzenji/Eikando-michi`	**¥1,000** normally ¥1,500 during the autumn exhibition 09:00–17:00	Map
12:15	**Lunch: yudofu at Okutan, on the Nanzen-ji grounds** Tofu simmered in kombu broth at the table, with sesame and seasonal sides. One set only, no à la carte. This is the 17th-century original, under the trees beside the temple; arrive before noon or expect to queue in autumn. `Inside the Nanzen-ji precinct, right of the Hōjō`	**¥3,500** for the set 11:00–15:45 weekdays, to 16:15 weekends **Closed Thursdays**	Map
13:45	**Nanzen-ji** Grounds are free and worth an hour: the huge Sanmon gate, the Meiji-era brick aqueduct running through the grounds, and the abbot's quarters with sliding-screen paintings and a raked gravel garden. The sub-temple Nanzen-in reopens for November only (1–30 Nov 2026), and the Hattō hall interior opens 16–29 Nov, closed 26 Nov. `Subway Keage, or bus Nanzenji/Eikando-michi`	Grounds **free** Hōjō garden **¥600** Sanmon gate **¥600** · Nanzen-in **¥500** 08:40–17:00 (to 16:30 Dec–Feb)	Map
15:15	**Heian Jingū and the Shin'en garden** A half-size replica of the Heian palace, painted vermilion, and behind it a strolling garden in four parts around a pond — the best late-afternoon	Shrine **free** · Shin'en **¥600** Gates 06:00–17:00 in	Map

TIME	STOP	HOURS · FEE	
	colour on this side of the city. The shrine is free; only the garden is ticketed. `Bus to Okazaki, or Higashiyama subway station`	November; garden reception from 08:30, last entry 16:30	
16:00	**Gion: Hanamikoji and the Shirakawa canal** Wooden townscape and a willow-lined canal, best in the last hour of daylight as the lanterns come on and the maiko walk to their evening appointments. Photography is restricted on the private lanes — the signs are explicit and it is enforced. `Keihan Gion-Shijō, or walk down from Maruyama Park`	Free Any time	Map
16:45	**Ninenzaka & Sannenzaka, up to Kiyomizu-dera** The two stepped lanes below the temple in early-evening light. Kiyomizu-dera stays open late: go up for the wooden stage over the valley at dusk, and if your dates allow, stay on for the special night viewing. `Bus 206 to Kiyomizu-michi, or walk up from Gion`	Lanes free Kiyomizu-dera **¥500** (*check* — the temple publishes hours but not the fee) 06:00–18:00; night viewing **21–30 Nov 2026**, to 21:30 with last entry 21:00	Map
19:00	**Evening: dinner, then a lit temple** Eat on Kiyomizu-zaka or back down in Gion, then take one of two illumination walks. Kōdai-ji, five minutes uphill from Kiyomizu-zaka, is lit from 17:00 to 22:00 and admits on the same ¥800 day ticket during 23 Oct – 13 Dec 2026. Or re-enter Kiyomizu-dera for the night viewing. `Walk or short taxi between the two`	Kōdai-ji **¥800** Kōdai-ji + Entoku-in **¥1,200** 09:00–22:00 in the illumination period	Map

> **If it rains, or you run out of legs:** cut the northern half and make it a short day — Ginkaku-ji, the canal, lunch, Nanzen-ji, then straight down to Gion. Two indoor substitutes sit on this route: **Kennin-ji** in Gion, Japan's oldest Zen temple, with the twin dragons on the hall ceiling (¥800, last entry 16:30; rising to ¥1,000 on 1 January 2027), and the **Kyoto Municipal Museum of Art** at Okazaki, beside Heian Jingū.

DAY TWO · WESTERN KYOTO

Arashiyama and the hillside temples

Tenryū-ji → Otagi Nenbutsu-ji
~12 km on foot

START	FINISH	TEMPLES & ENTRY	FOOD THREAD
08:00 Tenryū-ji	**Saga-Toriimoto**	**~¥3,700**	**Unagi · yuba · matcha**

Arashiyama is the west end of the city, where the river comes out of the mountains. Most visitors see the bridge, the bamboo and nothing else; this day keeps going north up the old pilgrimage lane, past six small temples that between them hold moss gardens, a thousand small stone figures and the best maple valley in Kyoto — with almost nobody in them.

TIME	STOP	HOURS · FEE	
08:00	**Tenryū-ji** A UNESCO World Heritage Zen temple, and the garden by Musō Soseki is the reason to come: a pond garden designed to be walked, with the hills borrowed as scenery. In autumn it opens its garden from 07:30 for early viewing (14–30 Nov 2026), which is the quietest hour of the day here. The Cloud Dragon ceiling in the Hattō is on special view until 6 Dec 2026. `JR Saga-Arashiyama, or Randen tram to Arashiyama`	Garden **¥500** Garden + halls **¥800** 08:30–17:00; from 07:30 during the November early viewing	Map
09:15	**The bamboo grove — and Nonomiya Shrine inside it** Free, short, and best before 09:30 or after 16:00. Walk it northwards: at the far end, hidden among the stalks, is Nonomiya, a small shrine where imperial priestesses were once purified before going to Ise. `North gate of Tenryū-ji, then straight on`	Free Open; shrine 09:00–17:00	Map
09:45	**Ôkōchi Sansō villa** The mountain estate of a silent-film star, on the ridge above the bamboo: a circuit of tea houses and gardens with the whole city laid out below. The ticket includes matcha and a sweet in the tea pavilion, which is exactly what you want by this point. `Exit the bamboo grove at its north end`	**¥1,000**, includes matcha and a sweet 09:00–17:00	Map
10:45	**Jōjakkō-ji** A Nichiren temple on the slope of Mount Ogura with a thatched gate, a two-storey pagoda and the best view in Arashiyama from the steps above the main hall. Its maples are the ones on the posters; it is also the steepest stop of the day. `Up the lane from the bamboo grove`	**~¥400** *(guidebook figure; the temple does not publish it)* 09:00–17:00	Map
11:30	**Nison-in** A long straight avenue of maples climbing to a temple that houses two Buddha images side by side — one teaching, one saving. Quiet, and one of the few temples here with no crowd at all. `Beside the road to Saga-Toriimoto`	**¥500** (primary school free) 09:00–16:30, no closing days	Map
12:45	**Lunch: unagi at Hirokawa, or tofu at Shintogetsu** Hirokawa grills eel over charcoal to order — the reason to plan this day around a booking. **Every seat is by reservation, and the phone line opens exactly one month before your date** (075-871-5226, Japanese; there is a multilingual online booking for visitors from abroad). A no-show costs ¥3,000 per person. If you would rather not book, Shintogetsu does yudofu and soba sets five minutes away for a fraction of the price. `Both on the lane below Tenryū-ji`	Hirokawa: unajū **¥3,900** plus 10% tax ≈ ¥4,290 11:00–15:00 and 17:00–21:00, **closed Mondays** Shintogetsu: sets **¥650–1,300**, 11:00–17:00	Map

TIME	STOP	HOURS · FEE	
14:15	**Giō-ji** The smallest and loveliest temple on the walk: a thatched hermitage in a bowl of brilliant green moss, built for the sisters in *The Tale of the Heike* who took the veil after losing the emperor's favour. Twenty minutes is enough and you will want longer. `On the lane towards Adashino`	**¥500** (children ¥100) 09:00–16:30 last reception, viewable to 16:50 Combined ticket with Daikaku-ji **¥1,000**	Map
15:00	**Adashino Nenbutsu-ji** For a thousand years this hillside was where Kyoto's dead were left, and the temple that replaced the practice gathers some eight thousand small stone figures, one for each forgotten person, packed onto the slope. Behind them a bamboo path and stone stairs to the graves above. Utterly unlike the rest of the day, and the walk out here through the old village is half of it. `North end of the Saga-Toriimoto lane`	**¥500** (JHS/HS ¥400, primary free) 09:00–16:30 last entry Reception closes 15:30 in Jan, Feb and Dec	Map
15:45	**Otagi Nenbutsu-ji** The end of the lane, and the reward: twelve hundred small carved figures, each with its own face and its own hobby — a boxer, a drinker, a woman with a cat — cut by amateur sculptors in the 1980s and slowly being taken back by moss. Almost no foreign visitors, because it is twenty minutes past the last bus stop of the tourist route. Walk the last stretch along Saga-Toriimoto, one of Kyoto's three preserved old streets. `Bus 72 from Kyoto Station to Otagidera-mae, or walk out from Arashiyama`	**¥300** 08:00–17:00	Map
16:45	**Back over Togetsukyō Bridge — optional extras** Come down through the village and cross the river at dusk. Two things you can add if you have daylight or energy left: the monkey park, twenty minutes up the hill on the far bank (feeding the macaques is the draw; it closes at 16:00 and takes cash only), and the Hozu river boat, which runs from Kameoka down the gorge until late November. `Cross the bridge to Randen or JR for the way home`	Monkey park **¥800** (cash only), 09:00–16:00 Hozu river boat **¥3,900**, roughly hourly to 15:30	Map

> **The practicalities of Arashiyama:** trains fill up badly on autumn weekends, and the bamboo grove is a queue between 10:00 and 15:00. If you are here on a weekend, run the day an hour earlier and consider taking the first bus 28 from Kyoto Station (about 50 minutes) rather than the train. Everything on this walk closes between 16:30 and 17:00, so the order matters — do not start at the far end.

DAY THREE · SOUTHERN KYOTO

Torii at dawn, maples, then sake

Fushimi Inari → Nishiki & Pontochō
~11 km on foot

START	FINISH	ENTRY	FOOD THREAD
06:00 Fushimi Inari	**Pontochō alley**	**~¥2,200**	**Inarizushi · sake · market**

An early start, because Fushimi Inari with nobody in it is one of the great experiences of Japan, and by nine it is a procession. Then the maples at Tōfuku-ji, the old sake canals, and a slow evening of market stalls and counter seats back in the centre.

TIME	STOP	HOURS · FEE	
06:00	**Fushimi Inari Taisha — the full mountain loop** Ten thousand vermilion gates up the hillside, and the walk everyone photographs is only the first twenty minutes. Go past the viewpoint at Yotsutsuji and keep climbing the loop to the summit — about four kilometres and two hours through the shrine's other offices, small shrines and stone foxes, in near silence. Buy inarizushi from a stall on the way in. The shrine itself is free and open all night. `JR Inari, or Keihan Fushimi-Inari, both two minutes away`	**Free** Open 24 hours Stalls and shops from about 08:30	Map
09:30	**Tōfuku-ji** The maples here are the densest in Kyoto: a valley of them below the Tsūten-kyō bridge, and the temple charges accordingly in autumn. Do the bridge first, then the abbot's garden of the eight phases by Shigemori Mirei, which is the modern masterpiece of the day. `Keihan Tofukuji, or JR Tofukuji; walkable from Inari`	Bridge and Kaisandō **¥1,000** in autumn (14 Nov – 6 Dec), ¥600 the rest of the year Abbot's garden **¥600** from 1 Nov Autumn hours 08:30–16:00 (bridge), 09:00–16:00 (garden); grounds free	Map
12:00	**Lunch and sake in Fushimi** The old brewing quarter, a ten-minute train ride or half-hour walk south along the canal. Two good options: **Torisei**, a brewery's own restaurant in a converted storehouse, for grilled chicken and tank-fresh unpasteurised sake; or the **sake brewery lane** by the canal, eight kitchens around one long counter of more than a hundred labels, where the signature flight lets you taste across eighteen breweries in small glasses. `Keihan Chūshojima or Fushimi-Momoyama`	Torisei: courses from **¥3,300** *(hours not published — ring ahead)* Sake lane: tasting flight, grilled plates from about ¥1,000	Map
13:45	**Gekkeikan Ôkura Sake Museum** A 1909 brewery building kept as it was, with the tools, barrels and film of a working sake house. The ticket includes three tastings at the counter. **The whole building is cashless** since 1 July 2026, and it is worth booking online — the booking window opens two weeks ahead. Note the shortened hours on 10 and 20 November 2026, when it closes at 14:00. `Five minutes' walk from Keihan Chūshojima`	**¥600** including three tastings (20 and over) 09:30–16:30, last entry 16:00 Cashless only · closed over New Year and O-Bon	Map
15:15	**The canal, and Teradaya** Walk back along the Hōsen canal between white-walled storehouses, or take the small ten-stone boat that runs the waterway. On the way, Teradaya is the inn where the samurai Sakamoto Ryōma was attacked in 1866; the bullet holes and his pistol are still there. `Along the canal towards Chūshojima`	Canal walk free Teradaya **¥400**, 10:00–16:00 Boat about **¥1,000**, spring to autumn	Map

TIME	STOP	HOURS · FEE	
16:45	**Nishiki Market** Kyoto's kitchen: a roofed lane of about a hundred and thirty shops, five minutes from the Kawaramachi streets. Graze as you go — grilled dashimaki omelette, stuffed octopus, soy-milk doughnuts, a shop that has made tofu skin since 1790, and a knife shop trading since 1560. **The market's own rule is that you eat at the shop you bought from, not walking along the lane**, and there are no bins, so hand your wrapper back as you go. Most shops close around 17:00–18:00 and many take Wednesday off; go before six. `Subway Shijō, or Hankyu Kyoto-Kawaramachi`	Free to walk Shops typically 09:00/10:00–18:00, individual closing days Budget about **¥3,000–4,000 for two** grazing	Map
18:00	**Chestnut sweets before dinner** Late autumn is chestnut season in Kyoto, and the old confectioners run seasonal sweets through October and November. Two reliable shops: Kameya Yoshinaga, trading since 1803, and the Toraya shop by the Imperial Palace if you are that far north. A box of two or three makes a good thing to carry home. `Shijō and Karasuma, near Nishiki`	Individual sweets roughly **¥270–600** each Kameya Yoshinaga and Toraya both close at 18:00; Toraya shuts the last Monday of the month	Map
19:00	**Dinner: Pontochō** A single-file alley of teahouses and counter restaurants between Shijō and Sanjō. **In November there is no riverside terrace** — the platforms over the Kamo come down on 15 October — so this is indoor counter dining, often a set course. Budget for a seat charge of ¥500–1,050 per person and service of up to 15% on top of the food, and book: the good rooms here are tiny. `Keihan Gion-Shijō or Sanjō, two minutes away`	Mid-range course dinner **¥6,000–9,000** per person including seat charge and service Most kitchens 17:00–22:30	Map
21:00	**Optional last stop: Kiyomizu-dera by night** If your dates fall between 21 and 30 November, the temple is open until 21:30 and the walk down through the lit lanes of Higashiyama afterwards is the best ending to the three days. It is a fifteen-minute taxi ride from Pontochō. `Taxi from downtown, about 15 minutes`	**¥500** *(check)* Open to 21:30, last entry 21:00, 21–30 Nov 2026	Map

What it costs

PER PERSON, THREE DAYS

Built from the prices in the day plans, with a mid-range dinner each night. It excludes your accommodation and getting to Kyoto. Child rates are roughly half at temples; two adults are assumed throughout.

ITEM	WHAT IS INCLUDED	PER PERSON	FOR TWO
Temples & gardens	Day 1 ¥5,000 · Day 2 ¥3,700 · Day 3 ¥2,200. Grounds that are free, and the optional extras at the end of each day, are left out.	¥10,900	¥21,800
City transport	Buses and subways in the centre, plus the Keihan and JR hops to Arashiyama and Fushimi. A day pass at ¥1,100 replaces the separate bus fares on Day 1.	¥2,500	¥5,000
Food & drink	Three breakfasts or coffees, three lunches (one of them yudofu and one unagi), market and sake tasting, three dinners at ¥4,000–8,000 including Pontochō's seat charge and service.	¥33,000	¥66,000
Three days, two people, mid-range		**¥46,400**	**¥92,800**

How the figure moves

VERSION	WHAT CHANGES	FOR TWO
Lean	Garden only at Tenryū-ji, the abbot's garden skipped at Tōfuku-ji, casual lunches (¥900–1,300), no unagi, one dinner at a counter rather than a course.	about ¥57,000
As planned	**Everything in the three days above.**	**¥92,800**
With one kaiseki lunch	Swap the Day 1 yudofu for the lunch course at Kikunoi — ¥16,500 plus 15% service, so ¥18,975 each instead of ¥3,500. Book weeks ahead; it closes on the first and third Tuesday.	about ¥124,000
Splurge dinner	One dinner at Kikunoi instead of Pontochō: ¥22,000–77,000 per person plus 15%, so ¥25,300–88,550 each.	¥136,000 and up

Where the money actually goes: food, by a wide margin — roughly two-thirds of the total. The temples are cheap by any standard: the most expensive single admission on the whole plan is Tōfuku-ji's bridge at ¥1,000, and three of the three days' headline sights (Fushimi Inari, the Philosopher's Path, Nanzen-ji's grounds) are free. If you want to cut, cut dinners, not temples.

Three days for rain

SWAP IN AS NEEDED

Late November in Kyoto is usually dry and cold, but a wet day is not a wasted one: the temples empty out and the moss turns electric. These three days are built to keep you dry without giving up the food.

OPTION ONE · DOWNTOWN

Eat and shop under cover, all day

Nishiki Market is roofed for its full 390 metres, and so are the Teramachi and Shinkyōgoku arcades that cross it — you can move between the market, the old bookshops and the department store food halls without stepping outside. The market's own rule applies: eat what you buy at the shop you bought it from, not walking along. Finish at the Kyoto International Manga Museum, a former elementary school with a wall of fifty thousand volumes you are invited to sit and read.

Wagashi detour: Kameya Yoshinaga (since 1803) and Toraya's Kyoto shop for seasonal chestnut sweets, both a few minutes away.

Getting there: Subway Shijō, or Hankyu Kyoto-Kawaramachi.

Manga museum ¥800, closed Wednesdays · sweets ¥270–600 each · market grazing about ¥3,000–4,000 for two

OPTION TWO · HIGASHIYAMA, INDOORS

Museums and temple halls, south of the centre

The best wet-weather cluster in the city, three minutes apart. The **Kyoto National Museum** is showing *The Tale of Genji: Radiant Culture of the Japanese Imperial Court* from 6 October to 29 November 2026, with late opening on Fridays until 20:00 — a genuinely once-in-years exhibition. Opposite it, **Sanjūsangen-dō** keeps 1,001 gilded statues of Kannon ranked in a 120-metre hall, which is a thing to do on a grey afternoon. Then **Kennin-ji** in Gion for the twin dragons on the ceiling of the dharma hall, painted in 2002, and the Wind and Thunder God screens.

Getting there: bus 206 or 100 to Hakubutsukan-Sanjūsangendō-mae, or Keihan Shichijō.

National Museum ¥2,200 for the Genji exhibition (Fridays to 20:00, closed Mondays) · Sanjūsangen-dō ¥600 · Kennin-ji ¥800

OPTION THREE · FUSHIMI AND UJI

Sake cellars, steam and a train

Start with the **Gekkeikan Ôkura Sake Museum** in Fushimi — an old brewery building, three tastings included, entirely cashless, and best booked online a fortnight ahead. Lunch at the sake brewery lane by the canal or at Torisei. Then pick one: the **Kyoto Railway Museum** and the aquarium, which sit side by side in Umekōji Park, or — for the committed — the **Nintendo Museum** in Uji, twenty minutes further on. The Nintendo Museum admits by advance ticket lottery only, needs a Nintendo account and the full name of every visitor, and closes on Tuesdays.

Getting there: Keihan to Chūshojima, five minutes' walk to the museum; Kintetsu or JR to Ogura for Uji.

Gekkeikan ¥600 · railway museum ¥1,500 · aquarium ¥2,600 · Nintendo Museum ¥3,300, lottery only

Sources, and what is still uncertain

CHECKED 15 OCTOBER 2026

Prices and hours were taken from the institutions' own sites wherever they publish them, and cross-checked against a second source. Where the two disagreed I have used the official figure and said so. Anything I could not confirm is marked *check* in the plan rather than quietly filled in with a guess.

Still uncertain — look these up before you go

- **Kiyomizu-dera's admission fee.** The temple publishes its hours and its night-viewing dates but no fee anywhere on its site. ¥500 is the figure in current third-party sources; older guides say ¥400.
- **Jōjakkō-ji and Otagi Nenbutsu-ji fees.** Neither temple publishes its admission charge; ¥400 and ¥300 are the guidebook figures.
- **Heian Jingū's Shin'en garden fee** (¥600) comes from secondary sources; the shrine's own site lists the hours but not the price.
- **Torisei's opening hours and closing days** are not published on its English page. Ring before building an evening on it.
- **Minor rail fares** (JR to Saga-Arashiyama, Keihan to Chūshojima) are approximate; the ¥230 bus fare, the ¥1,100 and ¥800 day passes and the ¥500 express bus are exact, from the transport bureau.
- **Okutan's yudofu price** (¥3,500) is from listings, not the restaurant: the Nanzen-ji branch has no working official site. The separate Okutan Kiyomizu charges ¥4,400 and publishes it.

Sources

1. Wikivoyage, Kyoto and its district pages — the district structure, the classic walking routes and the Higashiyama traverse. `en.wikivoyage.org/wiki/Kyoto · /Kyoto/Higashiyama · /Kyoto/Arashiyama · /Kyoto/South · /Kyoto/Central`
2. Kiyomizu-dera, official — opens 06:00, closing varies; autumn night viewing 21–30 Nov 2026 to 21:30, last entry 21:00. `kiyomizudera.or.jp/en/location/ · /en/visit/special_night_viewing/`
3. Nanzen-ji, official — 08:40–17:00 Mar–Nov; Hōjō ¥600, Sanmon ¥600, Nanzen-in ¥500; November-only openings. `nanzenji.or.jp/index.php?cID=239`
4. Eikan-dō, official — ¥1,000, and ¥1,500 during the autumn exhibition 11 Nov–6 Dec; night illumination 20 Nov–6 Dec at ¥1,000. `eikando.or.jp/haikan.html`
5. Ginkaku-ji (Shōkoku-ji), official notice — admission raised from ¥500 to ¥1,000 on 1 April 2026; autumn special viewing 1 Nov–5 Dec 2026. `shokoku-ji.jp/ginkakuji/`
6. Chion-in, official — grounds free, gates 06:00–16:00; gardens ¥300–500. `chion-in.or.jp/guide/`
7. Kōdai-ji, official — ¥800; autumn night viewing 23 Oct–13 Dec 2026, open to 22:00, last entry 21:30. `kodaiji.com/haikan.html · /saiji.html`
8. Heian Jingū, official — gates 06:00–17:00 in November; garden reception from 08:30, last entry 16:30. `heianjingu.or.jp/news_list/time/`
9. Kennin-ji, official — ¥800, last entry 16:30; rising to ¥1,000 on 1 January 2027. `kenninji.jp/access/`
10. Tenryū-ji, official — garden ¥500, with halls ¥800; early-morning garden viewing 14–30 Nov 2026 from 07:30; Cloud Dragon special viewing to 6 Dec 2026. `tenryuji.com/en/ · tenryuji.com/info/2025/12/2026.html`
11. Iwatayama Monkey Park, official — ¥800 adults, 09:00–16:00, cash only, closed in bad weather. `monkeypark.jp`
12. Jōjakkō-ji, Nison-in and Giō-ji, official — Nison-in ¥500, 09:00–16:30, no closing days; Giō-ji ¥500 with last reception 16:30, or ¥1,000 combined with Daikaku-ji. `jojakko-ji.or.jp · nisonin.jp · giouji.or.jp/access/`
13. Adashino Nenbutsu-ji, official — ¥500, last reception 16:30, earlier closure in January, February and December. `nenbutsuji.jp`
14. Tōfuku-ji, official — autumn rates 14 Nov–6 Dec 2026: bridge and Kaisandō ¥1,000, abbot's garden ¥600, no combined ticket; autumn hours 08:30–16:00. `tofukuji.jp/guide/`
15. Gekkeikan Ôkura Sake Museum, official — ¥600 including three tastings, 09:30–16:30 with last entry 16:00, cashless from 1 July 2026, and shortened hours on 10 and 20 November 2026. `gekkeikan.com/museum/ · gekkeikan.co.jp/enjoy/museum/`
16. Hirokawa (unagi), official — reservation-only with the phone line opening one month ahead, a ¥3,000 no-show charge, closed Mondays, unajū ¥3,900 before tax. `unagi-hirokawa.jp/reservation.html · /menu.html`

17. Torisei, official — brewery restaurant of Yamamoto Honke, courses from ¥3,300. toriseihonten.com/en/
18. Kikunoi, official price notice — lunch ¥16,500 plus 15% service; dinners ¥22,000–77,000. kikunoi.jp/news/000046.html
19. Nishiki Market association, official — the market's own rules: no eating while walking, eat at the shop you bought from. kyoto-nishiki.or.jp/en/manner/
20. Kyoto City official travel guide — the same Nishiki etiquette rule, plus Fushimi walks and seasonal sweets. kyoto.travel/en/destinations/kyoto-nishiki-food-market/
21. Kyoto National Museum, official — *The Tale of Genji* exhibition, 6 Oct–29 Nov 2026, ¥2,200, 09:00–17:30 with Fridays to 20:00, closed Mondays. kyohaku.go.jp/eng/visit/info/
22. Nintendo Museum, official — ¥3,300 adults, 10:00–20:00, closed Tuesdays, advance ticket lottery with names required, in Uji. museum.nintendo.com/en/guide/index.html
23. Kyoto City Transport Bureau, official — bus fare ¥230 flat and the ¥500 express bus; Subway & Bus 1-Day Pass ¥1,100; Subway 1-Day Pass ¥800. www2.city.kyoto.lg.jp/kotsu/webguide/en/fare/fare_bus.html · /en/ticket/regular_1day_card_comm.html · /en/ticket/regular_1day_card_tika.html
24. The Asahi Shimbun, 18 March 2026 — Kyoto's resident-priority bus fares of ¥350–400 for visitors against ¥200 for residents, expected in fiscal 2027, so not applicable to a 2026 trip. asahi.com/ajw/articles/16378614
25. The Kyoto Shimbun, 9 October 2025 — the closure of Honke Owariya, the soba house founded in 1465, which is why this plan uses Gontaro instead. kyoto-np.com/en/articles/-/1268
26. Kyoto Kamogawa Nōryō-yuka association, official — the riverside terrace season runs 1 May to 15 October 2026, so there are no kawayuka seats in November. kyoto-yuka.com/shop/ponto.html
27. Gontaro, official — the soba house beside Nishiki used as the replacement for Owariya. gontaro.co.jp/kyoto/
28. Toraya Kyoto Ichijō and Kameya Yoshinaga, official — November chestnut sweets; Toraya 10:00–18:00, closed the last Monday of the month. toraya-group.co.jp/shops/shop-55 · kameya-yoshinaga.com/

> **How this was checked.** Every fee and closing time above was read on the institution's or operator's own page on 15 October 2026, then cross-checked against a second independent source. Three figures in the standard guidebooks are out of date and have been replaced here: Ginkaku-ji's admission, up from ¥500 to ¥1,000 in April 2026; Giō-ji, up from ¥300 to ¥500; and Tōfuku-ji's autumn bridge, up from ¥600 to ¥1,000 for 14 November–6 December. Two restaurants still recommended in current guides have closed and are not in this plan: Honke Owariya (January 2026) and Gogyo (2020). On the whole, the temples publish their hours far more reliably than their fees.